ESHAAN DHAVALA

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EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles **September 2024 – December 2027**

B.S. Statistics & Data Science | Minor: Data Science Engineering | GPA: 3.66

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

USAA (United Services Automobile Association) - Bank, San Antonio, TX **May 2026 – August 2026**

Data Science Intern

- Discovered a data quality gap using SQL in Snowflake-hosted credit card closure data where 72% of closures over the past year were logged under one vague code ('No longer needed'), hiding the specific reason behind over 25,000 card closures.
- Applied NLP-based BERTopic embeddings and unsupervised clustering to unstructured call-transcript data in Python, uncovering closure reasons hidden inside the catch-all code like financial hardship, competitor rate offers, and fraud-related closures.
- Improved closure-reason capture rate from 28% to 66%, strengthening the data foundation for future retention offer targeting.
- Presented three process recommendations to senior leadership: retrain representatives on accurate capture, redesign the cluttered closure-reason dropdown to add missing options, and propose a model to predict closure reason before the call begins.

Bruin Sports Analytics – Football Consulting & Research Team, Los Angeles, CA **January 2026 – Present**

Co-Chair & Research Analyst

- Built an AI assistant using Anthropic API and R to answer UCLA coaches' player data questions with reports in under 10 seconds.
- Developed the XGBoost field goal make-probability model for a live OT 4th-down decision tool (0.78 AUC), playbyplay.football.
- Built the tracking-data pipeline and pass rusher features for an XGBoost EPA model in a 6-person QB clutch-performance study.
- Co-lead an 11-person team rebuilding UCLA Football's player strength training data pipeline and dashboard features.
- Lead weekly research meetings, set agendas, assign tasks across 3 separate projects, and recruited 8 new members.

Bruin Sports Analytics – Tennis Consulting Team, Los Angeles, CA **March 2025 – June 2026**

Data Analyst

- Built an ETL pipeline in Python, writing functions analyzing serve accuracy and shot selection across all 26 season matches.
- Sourced data for 12 untracked away matches for a UCLA tennis player, reviewing raw match video to build performance datasets.
- Designed a Leaflet travel dashboard used by players, mapping venues with live weather, court conditions, and local activities.
- Created scouting graphics for players and coaches from opponent match data, informing prep and strategy across 8 matches.

Mystic Lake Casino Steakhouse, Prior Lake, MN **April 2024 – April 2026**

Server Assist & Lead Host

- Greeted and seated 300+ VIP guests daily as lead host, building client rapport in a high-end, high-pressure dining environment.
- Optimized tables to fit waitlists of 25+ walk-in guests into fully booked service, reassigning reservations to maximize covers.

PROJECTS

JournalToData – Personal Analytics Dashboard **January 2026 – June 2026**

- Architected a Streamlit app converting 131 days of journal entries into 15+ structured daily metrics via the OpenAI API in Python.
- Integrated Google Sheets API as backend storage, enabling tracking with auto-generated charts and visualizations.
- Logged 131/132 days; analysis showed mood peaked on Fridays (8.3) and gym attendance ran 68% on Mon/Tue vs. 11% on Sun.
- Deployed to Streamlit Community Cloud with secure secrets management via Streamlit's credential system, maintaining a private live dashboard with persistent Google Sheets-backed storage and an aggregate public dashboard on my portfolio.

PlayScan – ML Football Play Classifier **June 2025 – September 2025**

- Trained a ResNet-LSTM model to classify NFL play types from video frame images across 1,000+ samples.
- Curated and labeled a 1,000+ image dataset of football plays, cleaning raw video frames and balancing class distributions.
- Achieved 93% classification accuracy on held-out test data (vs. 37% baseline), validating the ResNet-LSTM play-type predictions

SousChef – AI Recipe Agent **April 2024 – June 2024**

- Developed a Google Vertex AI recipe agent that recommends personalized meals based on available household ingredients.
- Scraped and preprocessed recipes from PDF cookbooks to build a structured knowledge base for the agent.
- Applied NLP and intent recognition to parse natural language ingredient queries and return accurate recipe recommendations.

TECHNICAL SKILLS: Languages: Python, SQL, R, C++, Java | ML: PyTorch, Scikit-learn, XGBoost, BERTopic.

SOFTWARE & TOOLS: Visualization: Tableau, Streamlit, PowerPoint | APIs & Cloud: Anthropic API, OpenAI API, Snowflake.

INTERESTS: Football, UFC, Weightlifting, Music Theory, Co-Op Puzzle Video Games, Japanese Art History, Astronomy, Taco Bell.